

Student Contribution Statement for Assignment 1 (XC2/WP1)

Team Number	XC2/WP1
Project Title	Benchmarking and Securing Language Models Against Adversarial Prompt Attacks
Facilitator Name	Dr. Xinyi Cai
Student Contribution	
Student Name	Vaisakh Pariyacheri
ID	104800822

Contributions to Assignment 1:

- **Team Leadership and Coordination:** I served as team leader, facilitating communication among members and ensuring that all contributions were aimed toward the common project strategy. This includes:
 - **Leading stand-up and planning meetings**, which allowed us to track progress, delegate tasks effectively, and resolve blockers.
 - **Acting as the primary point of contact** for both our industry client (CSIRO Data61) and academic supervisors, ensuring smooth communication channels and alignment of expectations.
- **Section 2: Terms of Reference (Author):** I wrote Section 2, Terms of Reference for the project plan. This section outlined the project's objectives, scope, crucial success factors, and acceptance criteria. My work clarified deliverables such as taxonomy design, training data collection, paraphraser development, and evaluation methods.
- **Core Project Architecture and Prompt Paraphraser Concept:** I oversaw developing the core project architecture, which included the idea that the team should create a collection of prompts using social engineering techniques to systematically attack LLMs. I also recommended use of a prompt paraphraser, which is a fine-tuned model or API-based pipeline that transforms direct adverse prompts into indirect ones. This idea became crucial for our project process and was included in the final project plan.
- **Review and Integration of Team Contributions:** I reviewed drafts created by other team members (e.g., timeline, project background, risk, and establishment processes) and provided structured feedback. I also led integration working sessions on Microsoft Teams, where we merged all components to create a cohesive and professional final project plan.
- **Project Planning Support:** I helped the team plan project activities and schedules, ensuring that tasks were realistic, distributed fairly, and linked with deliverables. I also documented the tasks in our project management board (Trello Board).
- **Ensuring Consistency and Client Readiness:** As team leader, I handled final document formatting, sign-off, and submission readiness. This entailed ensuring that figures, tables, and references adhered to academic standards, and that the strategy meets both client and supervisor requirements.

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Student Name	Aarathi Narayanan Kadambatta
ID	104801951

I was responsible for writing Section 4 (Deliverables, Activities, and Capital Resources) of the Project Concept Design Report, ensuring this section clearly outlined what the project will produce, how the work will be carried out, and the resources required.

Detailed contributions:

1) Section 4 – Deliverables, Activities, and Capital Resources

- I defined the full set of project deliverables, including documentation of social-engineering techniques, a training dataset of attack patterns, a paraphraser model or pipeline, a prompt repository, an evaluation report, an ethics checklist, and final presentation materials. These deliverables give a complete picture of what the project will provide at its conclusion.
- I outlined the eight main activities the project will follow, from literature review through to reporting and presentation. Each activity was broken into clear tasks so the team has a step-by-step plan to move forward in an organised way.
- I identified the resources required to complete the project, covering software and tools, computing needs, access to academic knowledge, and university facilities. This ensures the team and supervisors know exactly what support and infrastructure are necessary.

2) Alignment and Clarity

- I made sure that the deliverables, activities, and resources were consistent with the project's objectives and client expectations, giving the section a logical flow that ties all parts of the plan together.

3) Architecture Support

- In addition to Section 4, I also assisted Vaisakh in defining the core project architecture, particularly in aligning how deliverables and activities connect to the overall methodology.

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Student Name	Arun Ragavendhar Arunachalam Palaniyappan
ID	104837257

I contributed as Tech Lead and Developer, owning the establishment sections of the design report, the system architecture, and the final quality pass. I ensured the document aligned tightly with the marking schema and was submission-ready for client sign-off.

Detailed contributions

1) Section 3 – Establishment (authored end-to-end)

- **3.0 Establishment:** Framed the section’s purpose and scope; showed how governance (decisions, reviews, risks) links to deliverables and schedule; added a simple roadmap so readers can see “what happens when” and “what good looks like.”
- **3.1 Processes, Procedures and Standards:** Defined team workflows and guardrails—protected main, feature branches, PR reviews, version tagging, decision/change logs—and lightweight QA gates (prompt safety checklist, evaluation checklist, attribution check). Connected these to risk, ethics, and reproducibility so every output is traceable from requirement → method → result.
- **3.2 Project Environment:** Specified the toolchain and working assumptions: collaboration (Overleaf, Teams), repos (GitHub layout), storage, de-identification rules, secrets handling (never in code; CI variables only), least-privilege access, and compute options (incl. optional GPU). Noted constraints/dependencies and how to work within them. Included reproducibility assets (fixed seeds, config files, run logs).
- **3.3 Project Team Skill Development Requirements:** Identified skill gaps and set a short, practical plan around our sprint loop (**discover → design → defend → document**): safe prompt design with placeholders; evaluation basics (attack placement; **ASR—attack success rate**—calculation); defence patterns (clear, task-relevant boundaries); repo/CI hygiene; and clear reporting (tables, plots, short summaries). Added quick-reference checklists and examples to speed consistent adoption.

2) Proposed system design architecture (diagram built from Vaisakh Pariyacheri’s design Architecture)

- Created the Draw.io diagram (“**End-to-End Flow: Three-Tier Architecture — SE Tactics → Paraphraser → Evaluation & Repository**”) from the system design authored by Vaisakh Pariyacheri, with clear labels and step numbers.
- Converted Vaisakh’s written design into a step-by-step visual: showed both **API** and **fine-tuned** paraphraser paths; included run metadata (**seed, model, config, placement**), **batch generation, deduplication**, and an **ASR threshold** decision point; added the feedback loop to the prompt repository and documentation log.
- Verified alignment with the report: each node maps to its section, arrows show flow and owners, and callouts mark safety checks and hand-offs. Where details were unclear, I confirmed them with Vaisakh.

3) Quality, rubric alignment, and finalisation

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- Proofread and edited the entire report for clarity, consistent terminology (e.g., “LLMs”, “fine-tuning”), and clean structure; fixed figure captions and cross-references.
- Cross-verified line-by-line against the marking schema (planning; ethics; cost-effective solution; IP & attribution; structure/readability) and strengthened content where needed — added **NHMRC National Statement (2023)** compliance wording, a **free-first cost policy** with token budgets and optional cloud-credit guardrails, explicit licence/attribution notes, and practical acceptance criteria.
- Checked formatting, pagination, tables, risk/schedule linkage, and attribution; confirmed datasets/examples are de-identified and third-party sources are credited.
- Coordinated the final draft, ensured completeness (all sections, figures, signatories), and facilitated client sign-off for submission.
- **Final Review and Submission Sign-off:** Proofread and updated all sections; standardised terminology and formatting; verified figures, numbering, and cross-references; confirmed ethics, attribution/licensing, and de-identification; ensured rubric alignment and acceptance criteria; validated budget notes and cost controls; completed appendices and change log; collected signatures, created the final PDF, and delivered for client sign-off.

Student Name	Aayudh Himanshubhai Vaghani
ID	104996006
As a supporting Developer Role Assisted in repository organisation, ensured budget supported deliverables, and contributed to reproducibility checks under cost constraints.	
Detailed contributions	
Section 8 – Budget	
• Drafted the complete budget section, identifying and itemising costs for API credits, optional cloud/GPU usage, and collaboration tools. • Balanced project needs with resource constraints, prioritising API-based solutions while including fallback provisions for fine-tuning if required. • Ensured the budget was realistic, ethical, and fully aligned with the project scope, explicitly avoiding unnecessary or non-permitted expenditures. • Linked the budget to deliverables, making sure financial planning supported the taxonomy, paraphraser, repository, and evaluation activities.	

Student Contribution Statement for Assignment 1 (XC2/WP1)

Student Name	Vikas Kadruvan
ID	104981442

I contributed as Documentation Lead and Section Author, owning the introduction and risk sections of the design report, creating the front page and document sign-off, and leading the documentation quality pass to ensure submission readiness.

Detailed contributions

Section 1 – Introduction (authored end-to-end)

- Introduction: Framed the project context, purpose, and audience, ensuring clarity for client, supervisor, and team members.
- Background: Described the client (CSIRO Data61), their focus on AI security, and the motivation for studying prompt injection risks.
- Key Project Personnel: Documented all stakeholders (client, supervisor, academic facilitator, and team members), their roles, and responsibilities.

Section 6 – Risks (authored end-to-end)

- Designed the risk register, identifying 13 project-specific risks such as data availability, ethical concerns, uneven contribution, stakeholder availability, and requirement changes.
- Classified risks by probability and severity and linked each to numbered mitigation strategies and contingency plans.
- Ensured risks covered technical, ethical, and team-related dimensions, with alignment to client expectations and academic standards.

Document Front Page & Sign-off

- Created the front page of the Project Concept Design Report.
- Proofread and edited the report for readability.

Student Contribution Statement for Assignment 1 (XC2/WP1)

Student Name	Samsun Gulshan Sheik Dawood
ID	105009251
Detailed contributions • Was assigned the Research Lead and Developer roles, and authored Section 5 (Organisation & Structure) and Section 7 (Schedule) of the Project Concept Design Report. • Proofread and formatted the report for better clarity, grammar, and readability. Section 5: Organisation & Structure • Stakeholders' identification: Listed all participant groups for this project: six student team members, three industry clients, and a Swinburne facilitator, plus testers (from the team for reproducibility checks). • Activities and Deliverables RACI matrix table: Selected the RACI matrix structure with justification, and built the matrix with columns = activities and rows = deliverables (as per requirement in the template), and populated each cell with the groups involved, in an RACI version (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed) to show the responsibility of each stakeholder. Section 7: Schedule • Gantt chart: Planned the eight project activities into a semester-long schedule, ensuring weekday-only starts and ends. Created the Gantt chart showing the sequence of each activity and their dependencies on each other. Marked external dependencies in red. Assigned two primary owners per task. • External dependencies: Listed the external dependencies and linked it to relevant activities in the Gantt chart. • Assumptions: Documented schedule assumptions (stakeholder availability, API access, timely reviews).	